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Report
Website Development

Laurea University of Applied Sciences

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Final Project Report

For this report I decided to make a portfolio website to include some of my written short stories, the same type I created for the bootstrap assignment, as I wanted to test what it was like to actually make a real website on HTML, as I had tried to do so beforehand using a Neocities provider to try and do it but found it increasingly difficult. So I tried my hand at it this time around and found the same kind of difficulty, but this time I had a lot more help than a half cooked tutorial intro to HTML.

Various features for CSS and HTML were used such as the placement of text, the nested structure of lists and the anchoring of other links through the use of the href tag, as well as the proper linking of images for the purpose of providing covers for my short stories.

The syntax for HTML is also very easy and convenient to use and remember, though it took me some time to get used to nestling things within the body, the header and the main and all those things that we took a long time to learn and push through, making things such as simple blog websites and the HTML assignments really helped push through new knowledge that I had no way of knowing in the past. While it took me a while to fully understand the use of tags and anchors, and I struggled with being unable to link different parts of the website to headings due to the lack of an id tag, I was at last able to do so with the partaking of this assignment.

Unfortunately, while I have used CSS style sheets for previous assignments, I still struggle with effectively implementing them into other things and successfully planning what I want done with specific pages, and am working in understanding the vast array of CSS options that can be used for documents, both internal and external. The concept of an inline CSS still appears threatening and intimidating to me, but I am doing my utmost to learn it and understand how it works through various other sources and reviewing of the material provided. However, for this and previous assignments I understood that it helps with effectively coloring the website with the colors and the preferences of the creator, to the point that I finally understood the importance of CSS and why it was that previous attempts to make website always appeared so barebones. I always thought it was something you had to implement within HTML but turns out its something you have to implement through CSS resets, preferably of the external type in my personal opinion.

Bootstrap components were very useful in this regard, and prior to the undertaking of this module I had no idea that there were such readily available tools like bootstrap to make customizing websites useful. Components like the Navbar did not appear as useful as they were displayed to be, but things like the progress bar were actually quite useful for my purpose of preparing a portfolio, since it allowed me to present just how much the progress, I had in my own work was and how I could show that to others reading the website. Admittedly it was quite difficult to find five components useful for my project work, but ultimately, I managed to find some that would serve the purpose of preparing a writing portfolio for others to study and observe from afar. As for the website responsiveness, I used Bootstraps instructions on how to make websites much more responsive for mobile devices and all types of devices, made easier by their array of options that show how different container settings work in different devices, i.e how they would display and what seeing are best for global device use, and I tested my own website using my own mobile phone and other smaller laptops to see if they would display properly. Admittedly it wasn't the ideal size I would prefer for a website, but I believe it fit the aesthetic of a simply portfolio where I could post some of my work without presuming or assuming too much.

The most challenging part of this project was effectively implementing items from Bootstrap and remembering how HTML works and trying to puzzle out why certain things didn't work and having to go back to previous modules and information to reread and recheck how everything works (id and class tags, for instance, as well as linking to other websites). Through trial and error, careful analyses of the code written and interacting with a live version of the webpage I was slowly able to piece together how it was that certain pieces of coded operated and what tweaks and changes actually did. It helped me a lot to see the website change in real time to understand what exactly I was doing, and it was very rewarding and refreshing to see those things unfold.

I've learned from this project that it is rather hard to develop websites and that there is still a lot I need to learn and consider in regards to how to make a successful and pleasing website, how to realize my own vision and that it takes a lot of effort to post text to a website, more than I initially thought. As for the self-assessment of this assignment, I would unfortunately give myself a 2, since it isn't something particularly impressive or well done, but rather the efforts of someone new to coding and haphazardly made, still unsure of how code effectively works but struggling to make things stick together and function by any means necessary.